

Copenhagen, 28 January 2026

Dear Members of the Selection Committee,

I am writing to apply for the role of External Golf Agronomic Consultant at Royal Zoute Golf Club.

Having spent more than twenty years as a practicing greenkeeper at one of Europe's most respected and tightly regulated golf courses, I am strongly motivated by the opportunity to support a leading links course in maintaining excellence while transitioning towards fully pesticide-free management.

My career has been shaped by working at the intersection of turf performance, sustainability and increasingly strict legislation. As Head Greenkeeper at Royal Copenhagen Golf Club for nearly two decades, I have guided the course through a complete transition from conventional management to a resilient, zero-pesticide approach — all while safeguarding playability, member confidence and long-term turf stability. This experience has given me a deep, practical understanding of what it takes to manage disease pressure, stress situations and seasonal challenges without relying on chemical solutions.

Links-style, low-input management, fine-grass conversion, careful timing of interventions and disciplined decision-making have been central to my greenkeeping at Royal Copenhagen creating durable playing surfaces under operational and climatic pressure.

Alongside my operational experience, I co-founded a close professional network of leading head greenkeepers in Denmark more than twenty years ago. Through regular knowledge exchange and constructive sparring, we have collectively developed and refined approaches to pesticide-free course management. This knowledge exchange has given me insight into multiple courses, challenges and solutions allowing me to draw on a wide practice and knowledge base when advising clubs in transition. It is my ambition with my consultancy to bring this constructive sparring approach to Royal Zoute.

I recognise that choosing a long-standing practitioner rather than a traditional agronomist may be seen as a less conventional route. I believe this is also the key strength I bring as a consultant: the ability to combine strategic perspective with a deep understanding of day-to-day realities, enabling clear, realistic advice at every stage of a transition — from long-term planning to practical implementation and follow-up.

Royal Zoute's ambition to combine outstanding playing quality with a zero-pesticide future aligns closely with my professional values and personal passion for sustainable golf course management. I would welcome the opportunity to contribute as an independent sparring partner, supporting the club with objective advice, calm decision-making and long-term agronomic perspective.

Kind regards,

Martin Nilsson